

A full-page photograph of Ronaldo Nazário in his Brazil national team kit (yellow jersey with green trim, blue shorts with white trim, and white socks). He is captured in a dynamic pose, running towards the right side of the frame while looking down at a soccer ball on the grass. The background is a blurred stadium filled with spectators.

Ronaldo Nazário

A look at Ronaldo Nazário's World Cup record with Brazil shows two titles — 1994 and 2002. But he came close to adding another in between, when Brazil lost to France in the 1998 final.

Ronaldo was in fine form to guide his nation towards a fifth title in 1998, scoring four goals and providing three assists on the road to the final. But tragedy struck when he suffered a convulsive fit just hours before the summit clash, rendering him powerless against the eventual champion.

Redemption, however, was on the horizon.

He arrived at the 2002 edition with questions surrounding his fitness following a serious knee injury, and his solution to divert attention was simple: get an absurd haircut.

The iconic look became one of the highlights of the tournament, while Ronaldo let his goals do the talking. He found the back of the net in every game except the quarterfinal and finished with eight goals, including a match-winning brace against Germany in the final.

The triumph in South Korea and Japan might have been his first World Cup title on the pitch, but it was enough to secure his place among the best to ever do it.